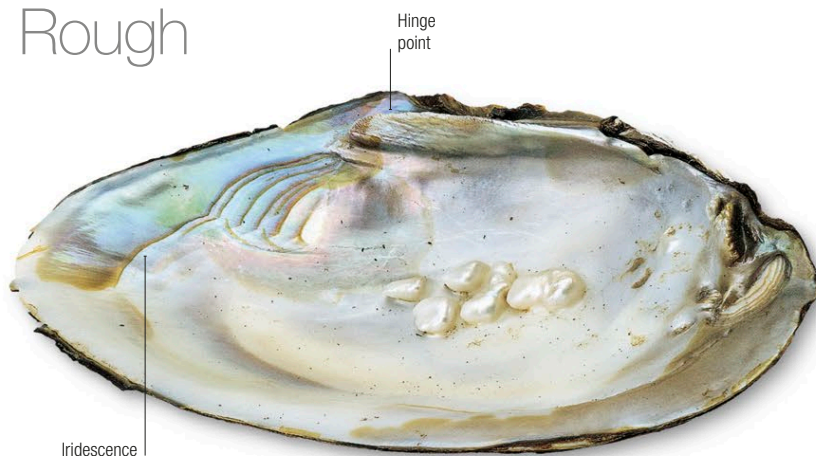


Rough



Mother-of-pearl | The lining of pearl-producing molluscs, mother-of-pearl, is the same material as pearl – a mixture of aragonite in conchiolin called nacre. It can be seen lining the interior of this shell with an iridescent sheen.

Settings



Gold and pearl pin | Created in the form of a eight-pointed star, this gold pin is set with a large central pearl, pearls on each point, and pearls on “rays”.



Baroque pearl | While perfectly round pearls are considered the most desirable by some, baroque pearls such as this black pearl offer more creativity for the jeweller.



Freshwater baroque white pearl | This baroque, white pearl is the kind that could provide the centrepiece for a whimsical sculptured gold jewellery piece.



Freshwater pearls | Freshwater pearls such as these have exactly the same makeup and lustre as saltwater pearls, and were more accessible to ancient man.



Baroque necklace | This Van Cleef & Arpels necklace uses baroque pearls – 11 drop-shaped pearls suspended from a necklace of diamond-set gold beads.

The Palawan Princess

The world's second largest pearl

Found in the coastal waters off the Island of Palawan in the Philippines, the Palawan Princess is the world's second largest known pearl, weighing 2.27kg (5lb) – equivalent to 11,340 carats. The product of the giant clam shell species *Tridacna giga*, the pearl is not considered a gem pearl because it is non-nacreous and lacks the lustre of gem pearls. Nevertheless, it was valued at around \$300,000–\$400,00 in 2009.



Palawan princess It has been said that the pearl's shape bears an uncanny resemblance to a human brain.



Cultivated pearls | This group of four pearls are all cultivated, and display the colour variations possible depending on the growth environment.



Multi-coloured pearl earrings | These pendant earrings set in 18-karat white gold feature pearl drops of three different colours suspended from diamond-set mountings.